



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Heritage School
School Website: <https://heritageschool.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Heritage School TX 78624 presents a robust Classical Christian profile. Public materials consistently frame the school as "classical" and "Christ-centered," with explicit emphasis on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, and the Great Conversation as core curricular and cultural anchors. The site foregrounds formation, virtue, and wisdom as primary aims, rather than mere information transfer, and it positions faith, character, and servant leadership as central outcomes. Across categories, the strongest signals come from explicit religious/theological framing, a liberal-arts curriculum built around classical methods, and a mission-centered faculty culture. While the website clearly articulates major elements of classical education (Element 1–3 and Element 6), some details of pedagogy and faculty portraiture are less explicit on public pages, which yields a few areas that are only partially explicit in classical pedagogy and faculty narrative (Categories 4–5). Overall, Heritage School TX 78624 aligns most strongly with classical education principles and earns a CLASSICAL rating overall.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence:** The school explicitly identifies itself as Christ-centered and Christian; the Bible is described as the source of truth; sermons of virtue and servant leadership recur; core values include Christ-Centered, Arete, and Hupomone. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include Christ-centered, truth, God, glorify God, virtue, character, servant leadership, Arete, Hupomone, theology. Negative signals (relativism, secular humanism, etc.) are not evident in public materials. Estimated positive keyword presence is high (near 100% of the enumerated positive indicators). Why this rating: Public materials ground education in transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) anchored by a Christian theistic framework, with explicit references to virtue and character formation in a theologically oriented context.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence:** The ultimate aim is formation (virtue, wisdom) rather than information or workforce training; the school embraces liberal education and Great Books as vehicles for "formation" and "Great Conversation"; emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty as real. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, Great Conversation, Great Books, classical heritage. Negative signals (workforce- or job-prep emphasis) are not evidenced; college-prep is framed as a pathway rather than the sole aim. Estimated positive keyword presence: high. Why this rating: The materials consistently center formation and moral achievement over merely vocational outcomes, aligning with classical aims of paideia and the pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful.
- **Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Explicit reference to the trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, primary sources, Western civilization/history emphasis, and classical language study potential (Latin/Greek framing). The Great Conversation is foregrounded as a curricular and cultural ideal. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include liberal arts, trivium, gram-

mar, logic, rhetoric, great books, great conversation, history/Western civilization, classical languages. Negative signals (e.g., social studies framing replacing history or project-based dominance) are not present in the public materials. Estimated positive keyword presence: very high. Why this rating: The curriculum is unmistakably built around classical liberal arts, the Trivium, and engagement with foundational Western texts, consistent with classical education norms.

- **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** Public materials emphasize the Trivium and Great Books as central, with a philosophy of formation and contemplation; explicit lower- vs. upper-school pedagogical modes are not exhaustively enumerated on public pages, though the Great Conversation and foundational Trivium are present. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include the Trivium, Great Books, Great Conversation, and a focus on memory, recitation, discussion in line with classical pedagogy. Explicit mentions of practices like Socratic seminars, memory work, chanting, and scholé days are not clearly enumerated on the public pages provided. Negative indicators are not evident. Estimated positive keyword presence is substantial but not exhaustive, yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signal. Why this rating: While core classical elements are present (Trivium, Great Books, Great Conversation), explicit, public-facing descriptions of specific pedagogical practices (e.g., Socratic seminars, memory work, scholé days) are not consistently documented on the pages retrieved, resulting in a partial—but clear—classical pedagogy signal.
- **Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence:** The site presents the Head of School and mission-focused statements; core values emphasize virtue and character; there are mentions of mentorship and living curriculum in the broader classical tradition, though explicit public narratives about faculty as mentors, “living curriculum,” or portraits of teacher ideals are less prominent on the retrieved pages. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include virtue/character formation, living curriculum concepts from classical tradition (implied by core values and mission), and collegial expectations (implied by a classical community). Negative indicators (explicitly weak or absent statements about faculty as “living curriculum” portraits or explicit faculty pedagogy language) are not strongly present in public pages. Overall, a partial but meaningful classical faculty signal is detectable. Why this rating: The school’s public materials foreground virtuous role models and mentorship in a classical Christian frame, but explicit, codified statements about faculty as the “living curriculum” or specific faculty formation programs are not strongly documented in the pages available.
- **Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence:** There is clear emphasis on partnerships with families (core values include family orientation), admissions processes inviting parent involvement (Parent Preview; open campus; tours), and tuition assistance programs that reflect a community-oriented, liturgical/values-driven environment. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with parents, co-teachers (implied by family-centric language), open campus, parental formation (via parent events and materials), and family participation. Negative signals (consumerism or minimal parent involvement) are not evidenced; the site presents a hospitable stance toward family engagement. Estimated positive keyword presence: high. Why this rating: The school communicates a strong, explicit family- and community-oriented posture consistent with classical education’s emphasis on parent partnership and formation.

Aggregate Assessment - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Rationale: Across five of six categories, Heritage School TX 78624 demonstrates strong classical signals (Religious foundations; purposeful formation; classical curriculum; community/family orientation). Pedagogy and Faculty show meaningful classical signals but are less exhaustively documented in public pages than the curricular and religious dimensions. Taken together, the school aligns with classical education norms (and explicitly identifies itself as classical Christian), yielding a CLASSICAL overall rating.

What Would Move the Needle

- **Element 4 (Pedagogy):** Provide explicit public documentation of specific classical teaching methods in practice (e.g., explicit descriptions of Socratic seminars in upper grades, memory work and recitation

programs, scholé days, or Paideia-style seminars). A public-facing section detailing daily or yearly pedagogical routines would strengthen the category from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.

- Element 5 (Faculty): Publish a formal portrait of the faculty as the living curriculum, including statements about teacher development, mentorship roles, and collaborative professional culture (e.g., faculty seminars on classical pedagogy, teacher-mentor programs, and a stated “living curriculum” philosophy).
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): Continue expanding formal pathways for parent formation (book studies, study groups, liturgical/family-learning events) and clearly articulate how parents participate as co-teachers in specific programs beyond admissions and events.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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